

Lesson 13 — Make Your Own Triggers

Matches LEGO Teacher Portal lesson: "Pet Feeder".

Objective (I can...): I can create my own events in a program and choose what each one starts. **CS concept:** Creating events in programs (choosing triggers and their actions) · **Builds on:** Lesson 12 (color events).

AI Connection (2 min, read aloud): People who build AI decide which events matter — "wake up when you hear my voice." They pick the triggers. *Ask the group:* "If you could pick one word to wake up a robot, what would it be?"

Materials: LEGO CS & AI kit + device per pair, color cards and (if the kit has it) a button/tap input.

Model reuse: Events model from Lesson 11 — code only.

60-minute flow - Warm-up (10): "Pick the trigger" — coach offers choices ("should a clap or a stomp start the dance?"); kids vote and act it out. They're choosing events. - **Concept + demo (8):** Show how to drop an event picture and attach any action to it. Build one event live, then a second, different one. - **Build/Code (25):** Pairs create at least two of their own events (a press or tap → one action; a color → another action) and choose what each starts. *Wiggle break + swap at ~12 min.* - **Challenge (7):** Make one event start a two-step action (move then light) while another does something simple. - **Share + tidy-up (10):** Pairs show both of their events and say which trigger starts which action. Model stays built.

Pair roles: Each partner owns one event they create; swap at the wiggle break to try each other's. (*Trio: three events, one each.*)

Differentiation: *Support* — one event, with a twin example to copy. *Extension / fast-finisher* — add a third event. *Reteach* — build one event start-to-finish together, then mirror it for the second.

Exit check: Pair's program has two+ events they created, each starting a different action. **At-home (optional):** Invent a secret trigger (a knock pattern) that means "come in"; teach it to a grown-up. ~5 min.